

2019 Season — Muddy Bushido: Samurai's Second Strike



League Overview

2019 was the season honor got dragged through the dirt. After TBone's fourth crown turned the league into a soap opera of swagger and side-eyes, order collapsed. Every team landed somewhere between contender and catastrophe — no one cracked double-digit wins, and every Sunday felt like a brawl in a rain-soaked pit. Fantasy football had never been so close, so chaotic, or so personal.

And in the middle of that storm stood Samurai. The noble warrior who once won with discipline and grace learned to fight dirty when the field demanded it. His lineup — powered by Jameis Winston's chaos cannon, Chris Godwin's breakout, and Saquon Barkley's thunderous finish — became the league's most explosive offense. Gone was serenity; in its place, survival. Every move mattered, every waiver wire was war.

Around him, the rest of the league flailed and fought: Wild Card's ironclad defense carried him to another near-miss, Razin stayed sharp but couldn't survive the storm, and Jack Wagons burst onto the scene with a playoff upset that shook the old guard. Even TBone, still basking in his 2018 glow, was humbled early by his rookie rival. The parity was maddening, the mud thick — but out of it all, the blade rose again.

This was Muddy Bushido — a season where Samurai traded his robe for rags, his elegance for endurance, and still carved his legend a little deeper into the Keeper League's scrolls.

The 2019 Super Bowl

Matchup: Samurai (7-6, 2429.43 PF, 2288.34 PA) vs. Wild Card (9-4, 2389.71 PF, 2286.36 PA)

Wild Card came in with the best record in the league, a defensive juggernaut built on Blake Martinez, Jaylon Smith, and Cameron Heyward. Samurai arrived as the mud-stained survivor, bruised but balanced — and armed with the league's best offense.

From kickoff, it wasn't close. Saquon Barkley detonated for 48.9 points, Darren Waller shredded coverage, and Chris Godwin continued his breakout. Jameis Winston, erratic all year, found redemption in the championship — airing out just enough chaos to light the scoreboard without burning it down.

Wild Card's defense, so steady all season, finally cracked under the weight of Samurai's storm. The final tally crowned a new two-time champion. The dojo was drenched, the robe torn, but the blade still gleamed.

Final Score: Samurai 210.95 – Wild Card 137.60

MVP: Saquon Barkley — 48.9 points, poetic destruction in the mud.

Summary: In a season where chaos ruled, Samurai bent his code and mastered the dirt — striking his second crown through grit, grime, and glory.

Team-by-Team Arcs

Samurai — (7-6 | PF 2429.43 | PA 2288.34 | 1st Place | League Champion | Best Offense Champion)

2019 turned the dojo into a mud pit, and Samurai proved he could fight dirty when honor demanded it. Jameis Winston's chaos cannon and Chris Godwin's breakout fueled the league's best offense, while Saquon Barkley's late-season explosion and Darren Waller's steady emergence gave him balance amid the storm. Every week was a coin flip of brilliance and disaster — but somehow the warrior kept his footing, grinding his way through the mess and into the postseason.

On defense, Jamal Adams led the charge with relentless aggression, Eric Reid and James Burgess Jr. piled up tackles like clockwork, and Tremaine Edmunds anchored the middle with quiet precision. That steady backbone kept the chaos contained long enough for Samurai to go supernova in the playoffs — 246 points against Razin in the semis, then 210 in a blowout over Wild Card for the crown. He didn't win cleanly, but he won completely.

Summary: The warrior mastered the mud — chaos, carnage, and a second crown carved from grit.

Wild Card — (9-4 | PF 2389.71 | PA 2286.36 | 2nd Place | Silver Medal | Best Defense Champion)

The gambler didn't change — he just refined the odds. 2019 was another Wild Card special: unpredictable, fearless, and just structured enough to look like destiny. Philip Rivers' steady hand, Julio Jones' dominance, and Leonard Fournette's bruising runs powered a top-tier offense, while rookie DK Metcalf added flash when games needed saving. The gambler's chaos always carried calculation — this time, the math nearly hit jackpot.

But his edge came from defense. Blake Martinez and Jaylon Smith formed a tackling machine, Jabrill Peppers flew everywhere, and Cameron Heyward anchored a front that bullied opponents into submission. It was the best defense in the league and the backbone of his 9–4 campaign. He escaped a 170–167 semifinal war before meeting Samurai's storm in the finals — a rout that ended his run but cemented his status as a perennial powerhouse.

Summary: The gambler played every card right — until the sword came down.

Razin — (7-6 | PF 2325.03 | PA 2325.03 | 3rd Place | Bronze Medal | later RAZINUDOWN)

Razin's 2019 campaign was classic — balanced, dangerous, and just a few lucky breaks short of another title shot. Russell Wilson orchestrated one of his sharpest fantasy seasons, Tyreek Hill stretched defenses thin with speed no one could match, and George Kittle provided the muscle and consistency that made every matchup winnable. Each week felt like a coin toss he somehow kept landing on edge.

But when the semifinals came, Samurai struck with one of the most ruthless performances in league history — a 246-point explosion that ended Razin's title hopes in a single night. He rebounded to claim bronze over Jack Wagons, steady as ever. After the loss, he briefly renamed his team to "Samurai's Slain" in good humor — a nod to another round in their timeless rivalry.

Summary: Another efficient, fearless run — same rival, same heartbreak, same fire still burning.

Jack Wagons — (7-6 | PF 2307.47 | PA 2290.55 | 4th Place)

For a first-year franchise, Jack Wagons showed up like a veteran with something to prove. Deshaun Watson and Russell Wilson rotated at quarterback like dueling engines, each capable of detonating scoreboards, while Michael Thomas' record-setting season and Derrick Henry's late-year rampage gave the offense the balance of art and brutality. Add in Josh Jacobs' rookie consistency and Devin Bush's defensive impact, and the Wagons instantly looked built for the long haul.

Defensively, Lavonte David captained a steady unit that hit hard and produced every week, while Myles Jack and Joe Haden kept games competitive with consistency that belied the team's inexperience. The Wagons rolled through the quarterfinals with an upset win over TBone, earning instant credibility before falling in the semis to Wild Card's veteran grind. For a debut campaign, it was a statement: this team was here to stay.

Summary: A debut built on power and poise — the Wagons rolled in and left ruts across the league.

TBone Manglers — (8-5 | PF 2502.20 | PA 2345.64 | 5th Place | Most Points Champion & Best Special Teams Champion | later TBone Diva Manglers)

Even in a season of mud and mayhem, the Manglers still found ways to feed the scoreboard. Christian McCaffrey was a one-man buffet, averaging over 31 points a game, while Nick Chubb, Jarvis Landry, and Tyler Lockett rounded out one of the deepest offensive units in the league. Ryan Tannehill's late-season surge gave TBone the spark he needed to finish as the Most Points Champion, but it wasn't enough to save him from playoff heartbreak.

The defense was rock-solid — Logan Ryan, Demario Davis, and Roquan Smith formed a punishing trio that kept the team competitive every week — but the postseason script didn't cooperate. A quarterfinal loss to Jack Wagons stopped the repeat dream cold. Even so, the Manglers once again proved that no one scores with more style, or more steakhouse swagger, than TBone.

Summary: The points poured in, but the crown stayed out of reach — the butcher cooked, the playoffs burned.

Super Saiyan — (8-5 | PF 2319.12 | PA 2289.41 | 6th Place)

The aura glowed, but not at full power. 2019's Super Saiyan squad was a study in balance — Kyler Murray's rookie spark, Davante Adams' steady excellence, and Travis Kelce's unmatched consistency gave him one of the league's most reliable offenses. Chris Carson and Devonta Freeman handled the dirty work on the ground while Cooper Kupp kept the PPR engine running. The results were solid, not spectacular — enough to keep him in every fight but never quite enough to dominate the battlefield.

On defense, Jordan Hicks was the heartbeat, leading a group that also featured Minkah Fitzpatrick's turnovers and Khalil Mack's edge pressure. Together, they formed a capable core that kept the team afloat through midseason slumps. A narrow playoff exit left the Saiyan hovering in that frustrating middle ground — too good to fade, not yet ready to ascend.

Summary: Strong, stable, but not transcendent — the aura was bright, the form incomplete.

Vegas Gold — (5-8 | PF 2167.20 | PA 2354.44 | 7th Place | Consolation Champion | formerly Las Vegas Gold / Thundering Koalas / Monstrous Malreese)

Vegas Gold didn't hit the jackpot, but he did win a few spins on the way out. Aaron Rodgers steered the ship with just enough flair to keep things interesting, while Aaron Jones and Alvin Kamara formed a backfield duo that looked unstoppable — at least in theory. Keenan Allen was his usual reliable self, but the rest of the lineup played like a slot machine stuck between payouts.

Defensively, Fred Warner and Zach Cunningham handled the dirty work, while Justin Simmons and Deion Jones kept the unit respectable. Then, like a true Vegas act, he saved his best performance for the small stage — catching fire in the consolation bracket to steal the draft-slot pick prize for 2020. It wasn't gold, but it was at least something shiny to polish.

Summary: The casino didn't pay out, but the house band still got an encore.

Dream Killer — (6-7 | PF 2279.46 | PA 2359.12 | 8th Place)

A name like Dream Killer promises nightmares; 2019 delivered mostly naps. Dak Prescott and Matt Ryan gave him a legit two-QB punch, but the supporting cast kept hitting the snooze. Even Ezekiel Elliott never quite broke games open in this scoring, and a TE room of Mike Gesicki and Jason Witten was more "gentle lullaby" than "scream mask." The result: a season of "we'll get 'em next week"s that ran out of weeks.

At least the defense showed teeth. Bobby Wagner and Luke Kuechly vacuumed tackles like Roombas in a sandstorm, and De'Vondre Campbell brought steady volume while the big boys up front — Linval Joseph and Fletcher Cox — did the trench work. They kept him in plenty of games... just long enough for the offense to misplace the dagger.

Summary: Scary name, soft landing — the dreams mostly lived, just not his.

TD Master — (5-8 | PF 2003.26 | PA 2338.49 | 9th Place)

The touchdown whisperer spent 2019 shouting into the void. Drew Brees (when healthy) and Kirk Cousins kept the lights on, DeAndre Hopkins did DeAndre Hopkins things, and Kenyan Drake's late-season heater teased a miracle that never quite arrived. Le'Veon Bell supplied cardio, not fireworks, and the TDs in "TD Master" felt more like a mission statement than a weekly occurrence.

The defense had pieces but not the punch. Vonn Bell and Jayon Brown piled up steady production, Shaq Thompson flashed range, and Tyrann Mathieu made just enough plays to keep hope alive... right up until the offense misplaced it. The result was a 5-8 slide into 10th — competitive in stretches, forgettable in totals.

Summary: Name says touchdowns; season said "maybe next drive."

SilentXecution — (6-7 | PF 2292.88 | PA 2397.21 | 10th Place)

The Executioner stayed dull. After a 10th-place stumble in 2018, 2019 felt like the same song on lower volume. Josh Allen led a scrappy but inconsistent offense that leaned on rookie Terry McLaurin for real juice, while veterans Odell Beckham Jr., T.Y. Hilton, and Alshon Jeffery took turns limping through Sundays. David Montgomery and David Johnson added floor, not fear, and by the time Noah Fant flashed, the damage was done.

Defense was the familiar bright spot, just not bright enough. Joe Schobert and Cory Littleton vacuumed tackles, with Tracy Walker III, K.J. Wright, and Matt Milano keeping games respectable while the front (hello Akiem Hicks, Quinnen Williams) provided sporadic push. He even snagged a consolation bye, then slipped to ninth anyway — a quiet fade for the league's quiet blade.

Summary: Solid defense, sputtering offense — the sword looked sharp, but it didn't cut.

MotorBoaters — (5-8 | PF 2038.27 | PA 2192.55 | 11th Place)

The engine never quite turned over. Patrick Mahomes kept the ignition sparking, Austin Ekeler did everything short of selling hot dogs at halftime, and Kenny Golladay flashed WR1 teeth — but the rest of the ride rattled like a loose prop. Todd Gurley and Joe Mixon provided more "meh" than motor, and by November the wake behind him was mostly just foam.

Defense? Plucky, not punishing. Todd Davis vacuumed tackles, Tre'Davious White erased WR1s on good days, and Jerome Baker flew around trying to patch the leaks. The boat still took on water. Another 5-8 glide into irrelevance — pretty paint job, empty gas tank.

Summary: Fast decals, slow boat — Mahomes gunned it, the rest stalled.

SCLSU Muddawgs — (5-8 | PF 1962.88 | PA 2256.51 | 12th Place)

The swamp was loud, messy, and mostly underwater. Lamar Jackson exploded for MVP numbers and still couldn't save this sinking ship. Amari Cooper and DeVante Parker made noise on the edges, Melvin Gordon and James Conner shared a rehab bench, and the rest of the offense was just treading water. The Muddawgs somehow scraped five wins — which, given the state of things, felt like a minor miracle or a clerical error.

On defense, there was star power but no bite. Aaron Donald and Nick Bosa brought pedigree, Chandler Jones did his best Terminator impression, and Kevin Byard vacuumed up tackles — but the rest of the pack looked like they were running in mud. Every week was the same: promise early, puddle by Sunday night.

Summary: Lamar soared, the rest sank — another season of mud, no gold.

Stats & Quirks

Champion: Samurai — The blade went dull, then cut through mud like butter.

Silver Medal: Wild Card — Nine wins, no crown — the gambler's jackpot still elusive.

Bronze Medal: Razin — Renamed "Samurai's Slain" after the semifinal massacre; bounced back swinging.

Most Points (Payout): TBone Manglers — 2502.20 PF — scored like a dynasty, finished like a diner special.

Most Points Offense (Payout): Samurai — Winston, Godwin, and Waller turned the dojo into a fireworks factory.

Most Points Defense (Payout): Wild Card — Blake Martinez tackled everything that moved — except the trophy.

Most Points Special Teams (Payout): TBone Manglers — Even his kickers served steak — special teams cooked medium-rare.

Consolation Champion: Vegas Gold — Didn't strike gold, but hit enough slots to pick his draft slot.

Lowest PF: SCLSU Muddawgs — Lamar soared, the rest sank — still splashing in the shallow end.

Fewest PA: Wild Card — Luckiest shield in the mud pit.

Most PA: Razin — Everyone wanted a shot at the Slain.

Closest Game: Wild Card 170.3 – 167.4 Jack Wagons (Semifinal) — Three points of madness separating glory from mud.

Biggest Blowout: Samurai 210.95 – 137.60 Wild Card (Super Bowl) — From close call to clean kill.

Heartbreak of the Year: Razin — Another great run, another Samurai scar.

Upset of the Year: Jack Wagons over TBone — The rookie broke the butcher's streak and the internet.

Comeback of the Year: Samurai — From 4–6 start to mud-caked champion.

Offensive Rookie of the Year: Josh Jacobs (Jack Wagons) — Brought horsepower to the Wagons.

Defensive Rookie of the Year: Devin Bush (Jack Wagons) — The other rookie who didn't blink.

Offensive MVP: Saquon Barkley (Samurai) — 48.9 in the title game — thunder in the mud.

Defensive MVP: Blake Martinez (Wild Card) — A one-man tackle monopoly.

Waiver Wire King: Samurai — Turned scraps into soldiers. True muddy alchemy.

Scandal of the Year: TBone's sideline steakhouse bet — Still denies it ever happened.

League Villain: Samurai — The noble warrior crossed to the dark side, and it worked.

Punching Bag: SCLSU Muddawgs — Five wins, all moral victories.

Obituary

None departed — Even the drowned crawled back from the mud.

Season Summary

2019 was the year the dojo turned into a cage match in the mud. Gone were the pristine stat battles and dynasty duels — this was survival fantasy. The standings were a traffic jam (11 of the 12 teams) of 8-5, 7-6, 6-7, and 5-8 teams, no one cracked double-digit wins, and nearly every franchise still had a shot at the playoffs down the stretch. By December, the line between contender and casualty was a single lineup move. The league was balanced, battered, and beautiful in its chaos.

Out of that pit rose Samurai, proving that even a noble warrior can win ugly. Behind Jameis Winston's chaos cannon, Chris Godwin's breakout, and Saquon Barkley's heroic playoff surge, he fought through the filth for his second crown. His 246-point demolition of Razin in the semifinals became instant league lore, followed by a 210–137 Super Bowl victory over Wild Card that sealed the mud-forged legacy. The dojo's code hadn't been broken — it had simply learned to brawl.

Around him, the chaos dealt its own deck. Wild Card played the table perfectly all season — 9–4 record, league-best defense, and a gambler's run that came up snake eyes in the finale. Razin reclaimed his form, fought to bronze, and even rebranded as Samurai's Slain in playful tribute to their rivalry. Jack Wagons charged into the playoffs with grit and horsepower, stunning TBone Manglers, whose 2502-point season still earned him Most Points and Special Teams honors. Super Saiyan stayed glowing but grounded, balanced yet one spark short of glory. Vegas Gold found rhythm at last, singing his way to the consolation crown and a draft-slot prize. TD Master flashed red-zone brilliance before fading, while SilentXecution's blade stayed sheathed in another uneven campaign. MotorBoaters revved hard early but sputtered late, left stranded in the mire beside the ever-sinking SCLSU Muddawgs, who once again made futility into folklore.

2019 will forever be remembered as the Season of Muddy Bushido — a year where every team swung, shuffled, or sank, and no one stayed clean. The dojo became a pit, the league became a brawl, and when the mud settled, Samurai stood tallest — a warrior reborn, blade stained, legend secure.

